

Oakland University

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP)

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Chatbot Solution

FILE 00291

Issue Date: March 17, 2026

Questions Due: March 31, 2026 by 2:00 P.M. EST

Addendum Issued by: April 14, 2026

Sealed Quotations Due: May 5, 2026 by 2:00 P.M. EST

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SECTION I – BACKGROUND

1.01 Oakland University Background Information

Oakland University (University) is a world-class academic institution located on 1,443 acres of wooded hills and meadows in Rochester, MI. The university was established in 1957 through a generous donation from founders Alfred and Matilda Dodge Wilson. Oakland University celebrated the 50th anniversary of its founding in 2007. When it opened in 1959, 570 students were enrolled, and the charter class graduated in 1963 with 125 students receiving diplomas. Today, nearly 16,000 students attend classes at OU, and our alumni total has grown to approximately 100,000.

As a state-supported institution of higher education, Oakland University has been recognized and is classified as a doctoral research university by the Carnegie Foundation for the Advancement of Teaching. With 139 baccalaureate degree programs and 127 graduate degree and certificate programs, Oakland provides a distinct educational experience with flexible class schedules and state-of-the-art facilities, student services, classroom technologies, research labs, internships and research opportunities with corporate partners. Located in the heart of Oakland County's Automation Alley, the university has forged hundreds of partnerships with hospitals, Fortune 500 companies, cities, government agencies and educational institutions.

All questions regarding this Request for Proposal should be directed to:

George Haight

Buyer

Oakland University, Purchasing Department

411 Pioneer Drive

Rochester, Michigan 48309

Phone No. (248) 370-4421

Email georgehaight@oakland.edu

1.02 RFP Overview

SECTION II – SCOPE OF WORK

The University's Technological Services Department (UTS) is soliciting requests for proposals from suppliers for an artificial intelligence (AI) chatbot solution. The University favors a turnkey solution that offers standardized templates with the flexibility for custom tailoring.

2.01 Statement of Work

The University is seeking suppliers with expertise in providing an AI chatbot solution that meets or exceeds the following requirements.

After review of the proposals, OU intends to invite selected suppliers to present their demo to the OU decision committee.

Please note that during the RFP process, direct contact with the stakeholder Department may result in disqualification of your proposal.

Project Overview and Scope:

1. **Primary Goal:** To implement an IT support chatbot to free up staff time, reduce ticket backlogs, and provide 24/7 support.
2. **Target Audience:** Students, Faculty, Staff, and Alumni (Internal and External facing).
3. **Key Use Cases:** Password resets (guidance only, no direct integration yet), software installation guidance, basic IT troubleshooting, and general university inquiries (bill pay, registration dates, campus locations).
4. **Departments Involved:** Primarily IT, but also includes classroom and events support.

Basic Requirements:

1. **Functionality:** The AI chatbot solution must support common IT service requests, including but not limited to password resets, software installation guidance, and basic technology troubleshooting. While not mandatory, the ability to automatically create, categorize, and route service tickets to appropriate support teams is highly desirable.
2. **Self-service support:** The solution shall enable self-service support by providing faculty, staff, and students with access to relevant and authoritative knowledge base articles, FAQs, and solutions. The chatbot should reduce reliance on live agents by enabling users to independently resolve routine issues.
3. **Integration:** The chatbot must integrate seamlessly with the institution's existing IT Service Management (ITSM) platform, TeamDynamix, including access to knowledge base content, ticketing systems, workflows, and service catalogs. The solution must support secure API-based integrations and be capable of accessing both online and approved offline knowledge sources and institutional websites.
4. **Training and Development:** The chatbot must be trained on a comprehensive dataset of known IT support issues and solutions relevant to a higher education environment. The solution should demonstrate the ability to learn from user interactions over time, improving accuracy, relevance, and response quality through supervised or configurable learning mechanisms.
5. **Maintenance and Support:** The solution must provide administrative tools that allow the institution's IT team to monitor chatbot performance, manage content, update knowledge sources, and adjust configurations as needed. Regular updates must be supported to maintain accuracy, performance, and security.
6. **User Experience:** The chatbot must offer an intuitive, user-friendly interface accessible across multiple platforms (e.g., web, mobile, portals). The solution should support personalization based on user role (student, faculty, staff) and preferences and comply with applicable accessibility standards.
7. **Escalation:** The chatbot must be capable of identifying complex or unresolved issues and seamlessly escalating them to human support agents, including passing relevant context and conversation history to reduce user friction.
8. **Data analysis and reporting:** The solution must provide robust analytics and reporting capabilities, including chatbot usage, resolution rates, escalation trends, and identification of

recurring issues. These insights should support continuous service improvement and operational decision-making.

9. **Feedback mechanisms:** The chatbot must include built-in feedback mechanisms that allow users to rate responses and provide qualitative feedback. This feedback should be accessible to administrators and usable for ongoing refinement of chatbot performance.
10. **Provide Natural Language Understanding (NLU):** The solution must demonstrate advanced Natural Language Understanding (NLU) capabilities, enabling it to accurately interpret user intent and context across a wide range of phrasing variations commonly used by students, faculty, and staff.
11. **Accurate and Helpful Information:** The chatbot must deliver reliable, accurate, and up-to-date information. Vendors must describe how content is curated, validated, and refreshed to ensure alignment with institutional policies and higher education–specific requirements.
12. **Personalized Interactions:** The chatbot should tailor responses based on user identity, role, and context, providing differentiated experiences for students, faculty, and staff while respecting privacy, security, and data governance requirements.

Knowledge Base and Training Data Requirements:

1. **Current Assets:** Approximately 715–750 knowledge articles primarily in HTML format.
2. **Storage Locations:** Wiki, Website, ITSM (TeamDynamix), and various online documents.
3. **Data Access:** OU will provide access to the full corpus for training. There is no single "data dump"; the bot is expected to scrape the website and integrate with existing repositories.
4. **Content Freshness:** Articles are newly created and will be updated/reviewed annually by UTS staff.
5. **Data Types:** Currently text-only; however, the bot should be able to parse PDFs/forms.
6. **Training Responsibility:** The vendor provides the training/tooling; UTS staff will be responsible for approving new learnings and ongoing maintenance.

Technical and Integration Requirements:

1. **Hosting:** Cloud-hosted is preferred (SaaS). All data must reside on US soil. There is no preference for a specific cloud provider (AWS/Azure/GCP).
2. **Integrations:** * TeamDynamix (ITSM): Core integration for KB lookup and portal deployment. APIs and a Sandbox environment will be provided.
 - Websites: Scraping capability for oakland.edu/helpdesk and support.oakland.edu.
 - SSO: Integration with Entra ID (SAML/SSO) for authentication.
3. **Live Agent Handoff:**
 - The University uses PureChat for live agents (approx. 10–15 agents).
 - Escalation to a live agent is required when the bot cannot resolve an issue.
4. **Deployment Channels:** Web only (ITSM portal and OU website). No current requirement for WhatsApp, SMS, or Teams.

Security, Compliance & Governance Requirements:

1. Compliance: Must follow University standards, including GDPR and FERPA.
2. Accessibility: Must comply with WCAG 2.1 / University accessibility standards.
3. Data Privacy: Item-level permissions are required. Data anonymization (PII protection) may be necessary during training.
4. Authentication: Users will authenticate via SSO on the portal/website.

Usage and Performance Expectations Requirements:

1. Availability: Chatbot must be available 24/7; Human agents are available 8-5, M-F.
2. Volume: * Total IT tickets: ~23,300 per year.
 - o Live agent interactions: ~150 per year (via current methods).
 - o Concurrency: Should handle at least 10 concurrent users and be scalable for semester start-up peaks.
3. Success Metrics: Accuracy, speed, and interpretability. While specific KPIs aren't set, the University expects reporting on resolution rates, common queries, and user feedback surveys.

Implementation and Costing Requirements:

1. Timeline: No fixed target go-live date; the schedule is to be proposed by the vendor.
2. Preference: Off-the-shelf (COTS) or configured solutions are preferred over custom-built models to manage costs.
3. Support: Vendor is responsible for product upgrades; UTS IT team will handle content updates and first-line monitoring.
4. Staffing: OU is not open to offshore resources; all project delivery and data handling must be US-based.
5. Licensing: Vendors can propose per-department or usage-based models.

Operational Details

1. Ticket Creation: Automatic ticket creation in TeamDynamix by the bot is a "nice-to-have" but not a Day 1 requirement.
2. Multilingual Support: English is the only requirement for Day 1; multilingual support is a "nice-to-have."
3. Blackout Periods: Deployment should avoid the start of semesters.

SECTION III - RFP PROPOSAL REQUIREMENTS AND SPECIFICATIONS

The supplier will provide all the product and services as listed in the statement of work section to the University's Helpdesk Team.

Term

The agreement shall be for an initial term of 3 years with annual payments, from contract start through June 30, 2029, and may be renewed at Oakland University's sole discretion, for up to 2 consecutive years, in one-year increments, through June 30, 2031. Prices and discount rates quoted and your responses to this Request for Quotation (RFQ) must be guaranteed for the entire term of the Agreement. Prices and discount rates quoted and your responses to this Request for Proposal (RFP) must be guaranteed for the entire term of the Agreement.

3.01 Plan of Action for Accomplishment of Services

All proposers shall provide a detailed Plan of Action for tasks as described in the Scope of Work including the following:

1. Solution overview: describe the proposed solution and how it meets and/or exceeds the above requirements itemizing each. Provide a detailed list of what is included with the proposed solution (e.g. integration customization; communication platform; etc).
2. Project summary: describe what the proposed solution can provide the University.
3. Implementation and training: describe what is involved in the implementation and training process. Provide a timeline that includes length of time from approved order to implementation.
4. Support services: describe your firm's ongoing support services and what is included.

3.02 Qualifications/Experience

Respondents shall provide experienced, qualified, and capable personnel to perform the functions and responsibilities as outlined in the Scope of Services. The Statement of Qualifications/Experience must clearly demonstrate the Proposer's relevant experience providing an AI Chatbot solution.

All Respondents shall provide a Statement of Qualifications/Experience that addresses the following:
Supplier Requirements – Please respond to each requirement.

- Organizational data that demonstrates the size scope and capability of the company to handle the University's specific requirements specified in this RFP
- Describe Supplier's experience with different size projects
- References from three (3) organizations, preferably higher education customers, for which similar services have been performed in the last five (5) years.

Responses must include the following OU required documents:

- A signed copy of the RFP indicating the Supplier agrees to the RFP in its entirety, including Oakland University's Terms and Conditions
 - Schedule A - Addendum Acknowledgement
 - Schedule B – Insurance Acknowledgement and Certificate (Informational Only)
 - Schedule C – Cost Proposal in Excel format
 - Schedule D – IT Technical Compliance
 - Copy of Contract/Agreement for review (if applicable)
 - Additional/Miscellaneous Information (if applicable)
- NOTE:** Vendors will be required to provide their Service Organization Control (SOC) 2 Type II Report when requested by the University.

Failure to submit information in accordance with the RFP requirements and procedures may be cause for disqualification. **Not submitting the insurance certificate may cause your company to be disqualified.**

3.03 University Liaison

The awarded Supplier shall designate and provide at no charge to Oakland University an official representative to serve as liaison with the University in overseeing the relationship between the Supplier and the University. Contact information for the liaison(s) should be provided and include name, title, phone/cell, and email address.

3.04 Cost/Fees

Proposals must include a fee schedule for the goods and/or services being proposed. The schedule should indicate all proposed costs will be held firm for a period of at least one hundred twenty (120) days following submission of the proposal.

Firms must clearly and unambiguously specify the cost of the services in their proposals. Any reimbursable fees should be identified separately.

Any other taxes, fees or commissions applicable to the proposed contract are the responsibility and liability of the proposer who must include these cost items in the price of the goods and services.

3.05 Freedom of Information Act Requests

The Supplier understands that the University complies with the Michigan Freedom of Information Act ("FOIA") and that the University may provide Confidential Information to other persons or entities upon receipt of a FOIA request. Section "z" of the FOIA states that security information is exempt from disclosure.

A FOIA request must be submitted in writing to the FOIA Office (or Coordinator). The request may be transmitted in hard copy, by email, or by facsimile. Refer to Oakland University's website for procedures and guidelines to submit a FOIA request - <https://www.oakland.edu/policies-regulations/FOIA/>.

SECTION IV – EVALUATION

4.01 Evaluation of RFP Response and Selection Criteria

Proposals will be evaluated by the University. If there are portions of any proposal the University finds unacceptable or otherwise in need of clarification or revision, the University reserves the right to negotiate with any or all Suppliers. Any exceptions to the specifications or any other special considerations or conditions requested or required by Supplier will be enumerated by the Supplier and submitted as part of its Proposal, together with an explanation as to the reason the specifications cannot be met. Each Supplier will be required and expected to meet the specifications in their entirety, except to the extent exceptions are expressly noted in its proposal.

The University will evaluate the proposals submitted in response to this RFP, based on the completeness of the information provided and the business and technical merits related to the goals and requirements of the University. The University will conduct a detailed review and evaluation of the company and/or team and all entities and/or organizations participating in providing the goods and services described in this RFP. The evaluation of proposals has one basic objective: to determine whether the proposer meets the requirements set forth in this RFP and has the best value proposal to the University.

After review of submitted proposals, OU reserves the right to request a demonstration of the product.

Proposals will be evaluated by the University against the criterion that follows:

Criterion:	Possible Points
Product functionality / User Experience	30
System / data integration (API's)	10
Support / Training	20
Implementation	10
Cost	30
TOTAL:	100

Proposals will be scored on a one-thousand (100) point scale in accordance with the evaluation criteria set forth above. Each Respondent must indicate its fees in accordance with section 3.05. Fees must be reasonable and justifiable and must reflect the proposed approach/work plan. OU will award to the responsive and responsible Respondent(s) whose proposal conforms to this RFP and whose combined scores under this section provide the best value. Notwithstanding anything contained herein, OU reserves the right to make an award based on any other relevant considerations and in the best interest of OU.

4.02 Presentations

OU reserves the right to make its award decision based solely on the written submitted proposals without any request for presentations, formal interviews, negotiations, or further discussions.

The objective of this presentation/discussion is to answer questions, clarify issues, and/or provide additional information regarding a Respondent's proposal and negotiate. Presentations will be evaluated according to criteria established by the evaluation committee. Respondents in the competitive range will be scored on a maximum 30-point scale. The resulting points will be added to their written proposal scores for a total score.

1. Oral Presentation

0-30 Points

Following the presentations, the evaluation committee will evaluate and summarize their findings for each firm that participates and will submit scores to the Procurement Officer. OU will award to the responsive and responsible Respondent(s) whose proposal conforms to this RFP and whose combined total score for price, compliance, technical factors, and oral presentations (if applicable) provides the best value to OU. Notwithstanding anything contained herein, OU reserves the right to make an award based on any other relevant considerations and in the best interest of OU.

4.03 Process for Award

Without limitation and at its sole option, OU reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals, to take exception to these RFP specifications, to negotiate with finalists, or to waive any informality. Firms may be excluded from further consideration for failure to fully comply with the specifications of this RFP.

OU may decide to reject all proposals and/or to reissue this RFP with modifications.

OU will not award contracts to proposers that are debarred, suspended or otherwise determined ineligible by, nor to proposers that OU has determined to be non-responsible.

OU reserves the right to make an award based solely on the original proposals received or to negotiate further with proposers. The proposer selected for the award will be chosen on the basis of an assessment of the greatest benefit to OU, not necessarily on the basis of lowest price. OU also reserves the right to negotiate and award any element of this RFP, make multiple awards, reject any or all proposals or waive any minor irregularities or technicalities in proposals received as the best interest of OU may require.

SECTION V - PROCUREMENT PROCESS

5.01 Submission Method, Date and Time

One (1) copy of the sealed proposal shall be submitted electronically. All responses must be submitted online via MITN, [BidNet Direct](#). Proposals must be received by **May 5, 2026 @ 2 PM Eastern Time**. Proposals will not be opened publicly. It is the firm's responsibility to ensure that its proposal is delivered at the proper time and place.

Expenses for developing and presenting responses to this RFQ shall be the entire responsibility of the Supplier and shall not be chargeable to the University. All supporting documentation and manuals submitted with this proposal will become the property of the University.

Unless otherwise stated above, proposals submitted are to be in accordance with the outline and specifications contained and are to remain in effect a minimum of 120 days from the date of submission, and may be subject to further extensions as negotiated.

OU reserves the right to accept or reject any or all proposals, and may cancel this solicitation at any time for any reason at the university's discretion.

5.02 Questions and Interpretations

All inquiries to this RFQ must be submitted in writing georgehaight@oakland.edu by **March 31, 2026 @ 2:00 P.M. Eastern Time**. An Addendum will be issued with responses to all questions received.

5.03 Withdrawal of Proposals

Proposals may be withdrawn by written notice to the prescribed OU Buyer, prior to the proposal deadline date. Negligence on the part of the Supplier in preparing the proposal confers no right of withdrawal or modification of the proposal after the proposal deadline has elapsed.

5.04 Price and Scope of Work Changes

All proposals should be firm and not subject to change by the Supplier for a period of one hundred twenty days (120) from the proposal deadline date. Note, however, OU reserves the option to negotiate prices downward and to negotiate additional scope of work and cost changes based on final negotiations with the selected Supplier.

5.05 Mistakes in Proposals

If a mistake in a proposal is suspected or alleged, the proposal may be corrected or withdrawn prior to the due date for this solicitation. If negotiations are not held, or if best and final offers have been received, the Firm may be permitted to correct a mistake in its proposal and the intended correct offer may be considered based on the conditions that follow:

The mistake and the intended correct offer are clearly evident on the face of the proposal.

The Firm submits written evidence which clearly and convincingly demonstrates both the existing offer, and such correction would not be contrary to the fair and equal treatment of other Firms.

Mistakes discovered after award shall not be corrected unless OU Counsel makes a written determination that it would be disadvantageous to OU not to allow the mistake to be corrected. The approval or disapproval of requests of this nature shall be in writing by OU's Legal Counsel.

5.06 Execution of Proposals

The original proposal must contain a manual or electronic (date and time stamped) signature of an authorized representative of the Proposer. The proposal must be typed or printed in ink. All corrections made on the proposal sheets must be initialed by the authorized representative. The company name must appear on each sheet. The proposal must include all documents, materials and information required herein.

5.07 Procurement Schedule

The University intends to conduct the procurement process expeditiously. Proposers are expected to comply with the procurement schedule, including any modifications thereto which may be made by the University. The University will notify proposers of any and all such modifications. Proposers who fail to comply with the schedule may not receive further consideration.

The anticipated procurement schedule for the RFP process is as follows; the University will make every effort to adhere to the schedule, and at its discretion is subject to change:

Issue Request for Proposal	March 17, 2026
Deadline for Written Questions Regarding the RFP	March 31, 2026 @ 2:00 p.m.
Addendum Issued by	April 14, 2026
Proposal Submission	May 5, 2026 @ 2:00 p.m.

SECTION VI – GENERAL CONDITIONS

6.01 Terms and Conditions

Any contract resulting from this Request for Proposal is subject to and shall be performed in accordance with the University's General Terms and Conditions for Agreement located at the following: [OU Terms & Conditions](#).

The University's preferred payment method is with a University credit card (Pcard). **The University will not accept convenience fees or increased pricing due to Pcard payment.** The University is tax exempt, State of Michigan tax is not applicable.

Any person, firm, corporation or association submitting a proposal shall be deemed to have read and understood all the terms, conditions and requirements in the specifications/scope of work.

Upon University request, the awarded supplier must agree to provide independently audited financial statements including its statement of financial position, statement of operations, and statement of cash flows for at least the past three years. Furthermore, the Contractor must agree to permit the University, upon request, to audit privileges, related to the University's account. Failure to agree to this may result in disqualification of your bid.

Purchase Orders issued to the Supplier throughout the term of an agreement for services shall be subject to any and all of the provisions noted in this RFQ. If there is a discrepancy between the information stated in this RFQ and the University's T&Cs, the T&Cs will apply.

This RFQ in no manner obligates the University to the eventual purchase of any products or services described, implied, or which may be proposed, and may be terminated by the University without penalty or obligation at any time.

Expenses for developing and presenting proposals will be the entire responsibility of the Supplier and will not be chargeable to the University. All supporting documentation and manuals with this proposal will become the property of the University.

The Supplier understands that the University complies with the Michigan Freedom of Information Act ("FOIA") and that the University may provide Confidential Information to other persons or entities upon receipt of a FOIA request. Section "z" of the FOIA states that security information is exempt from disclosure.

Smoke Free Campus: Effective Fall 2013, the University is smoke-free. Contractors are responsible to ensure that all employees and all subcontractors' employees are in compliance anytime they are on Oakland's main, or extension center campuses. The complete policy can be found at [Policy 475](#).

6.02 Conflict of Interest

The Supplier affirms that to the best of its knowledge there exists no actual or potential conflict-of-interest between the Supplier's family, business, or financial interests and providing the Services. The Supplier will not attempt to influence any University employee by the direct or indirect offer of anything of value. The Supplier also warrants that no officer or employee of the University has or will have a direct or indirect personal financial interest in the Agreement. The Supplier also affirms that neither the Supplier nor any of its employees has paid or agreed to pay any person, other than bona fide employees and consultants working solely for the Supplier, any fee, commission, percentage, brokerage fee, gift or any other consideration contingent upon or resulting from the execution of an Agreement.

In the event of change in either Supplier's interests or Services under this Agreement, the Supplier will inform the University regarding all possible conflicts-of interest which may arise as a result of such change. The Supplier agrees that conflicts-of-interest will be resolved to the University's satisfaction or the University may terminate the Agreement.

Oakland University reserves the following rights: to accept or reject any bid; to reject all bids' to waive any formalities or irregularities contained in a bid that do not comply with the terms and conditions of the invitation to bid, any modifications to the invitation to bid, or any specifications; to select the bid and/or items that in the sole and absolute discretion of Oakland University are in Oakland University's best interest whether or not the bid selected is the lowest monetary bid received.

6.03 Cost of Proposal

Suppliers are responsible for all their costs associated with the preparation of proposals. All costs incurred, directly or indirectly, associated with the preparation of proposals shall be the sole responsibility of and shall be borne by the respondents.

6.04 Form of Purchase

The acceptance of the proposed Firm's offer for the product/services specified herein will be made by issuance of a duly authorized contract or purchase order prepared by OU. Suppliers are cautioned to make no assumptions or accept any representations by any employee, member, officer or representative of OU concerning the award until a contract agreement is executed.

6.05 Government Restrictions

In the event any governmental restrictions may be imposed which would necessitate alteration of the material, quality, workmanship or performance of the goods or services offered, it shall be the responsibility of the successful Firm to immediately notify OU in writing specifying the regulation which requires alteration. OU reserves the right to accept any such alteration, including any reasonable price adjustments occasioned thereby, or to cancel the contract at no expense to OU.

6.06 Nonconformance to Conditions/Specifications/Scope of Services

Services will be inspected for compliance with specifications. Services not conforming to specifications may not be accepted at the Firm's expense. Services not provided in accordance with the Scope of Services may result in the Firm being found in default. In the event of default all procurement costs may be charged against the Firm. Any violations of these stipulations may result in the Firm's name being removed from OU's proposal mailing list.

6.07 Assignment or Transfer

The successful Firm shall not assign or transfer any interest in any subsequent contract, in whole or part, without written approval of OU. Claims for sums of money due, or to become due from OU pursuant to the contract may be assigned to a bank, trust company or other financial institution. OU is hereby expressly relieved and absolved of any and all liability in the event a purported assignment or subcontracting of the contract is attempted in the absence of the Firm obtaining OU's prior written consent.

6.08 Patents - Licenses and Royalties

The successful Firm shall indemnify and save harmless OU and its employees from liability of any kind, including cost and expenses for or on account of any copyrighted, patented, or not patented invention, process or article manufactured or used in the performance of the contract, including its use by OU. If the Supplier uses any design, device or material covered by letters, patent, or copyright, it is mutually agreed and understood that the proposal prices shall include all royalties or cost arising from the use of such design, device or materials involved in the work. Further all residual right to Patents, Licenses and Royalties (e.g., software and license to use same purchased) shall revert to OU at the end of the Agreement.

6.09 Permits and Licenses

The successful Firm shall obtain all permits and licenses that are required for performing its work. The Firm shall pay all related fees and costs in connection with required permits and licenses. Proof of ownership shall be made on all software used in the execution of the contract. The Firm will hold OU harmless for any violation of software licensing resulting from breaches by employees, owners, and agents of the Firm.

6.10 Taxes

The successful Firm is responsible for all state and federal payroll and/or social security taxes. The Firm shall hold OU harmless in every respect against tax liability.

6.11 Insurance Requirements

The awarded Supplier will be required to obtain insurance protecting Oakland University, Supplier and any subcontractor of Supplier performing services covered by the RFQ. The awarded Supplier agrees to immediately comply with the insurance provisions and maintain insurance levels at its sole expense. Supplier shall provide acknowledgement and evidence of such insurance prior to execution of the Contract, found in **Schedule B**. If you cannot currently meet the requirements, proposals must include a statement agreeing to meet these requirements at no additional cost by the time of contract signing. Failure to meet this requirement may cause the proposal to be considered non-responsive and subject to disqualification. **You must submit an insurance certificate (informational only) with your bid response.**

6.12 Proof of Insurance

The successful Firm shall furnish to OU a certified copy of the policy or policies covering the work as required in the specifications as evidence that the insurance required will be maintained in force for the entire duration of the contract with OU. OU must be listed as an additional insured.

6.13 Standards of Conduct

The successful Firm shall be responsible for maintaining satisfactory standards of its employee's competence, conduct, courtesy, appearance, honesty, and integrity. It shall be responsible for taking such disciplinary action with respect to any of its employees as may be necessary.

6.14 Background Checks and Debarment

Contractor has performed a police records check and/or criminal background check and that neither the Contractor nor any of its directors, members, officers, employees, volunteers, servants, agents,

representatives and designees, and subcontractors, properly appear on the Michigan Public Sex Offender Registry or has been convicted of a felony, criminal sex offense, forcible assault or any crime against a minor or any other person; and (ix) Contractor is not suspended, debarred, proposed for debarment, declared ineligible or voluntarily excluded from the award of contracts from United States federal government programs and/or agencies and is not listed in the List of Parties Excluded from Federal Procurement or Non-procurement Programs (collectively "Not-Debarred") pursuant to Executive Order 12549 and the regulations promulgated thereunder, 2 CFR 180, and any additional regulations promulgated by an applicable federal agency, and will obtain identical certifications from Contractor's lower tier contractors and suppliers that they are also Not-Debarred.

6.15 Removal of Employees

OU may request the successful Firm to immediately remove from assignment to OU and/or dismiss any employee found unfit to perform duties due to one or more of the following reasons:

1. Neglect of Duty.
2. Disorderly conduct, use of abusive or offensive language, quarreling, intimidation by words or actions or fighting.
3. Theft, vandalism, immoral conduct, or any other criminal action.
4. Selling, consuming, possessing, or being under the influence of intoxicants, including alcohol, or illegal substances while on assignment at OU.

6.16 Supervision

The successful Firm shall always provide adequate competent supervision during the performance of the contract. To that effect, a qualified consultant and one or more alternates shall be designated in writing to OU prior to contract start. The Firm or his designated representative shall be readily available to meet with OU personnel. The successful Firm shall provide the telephone numbers where its representative(s) can be reached.

6.17 Performance Evaluation Meeting

The selected Firm shall be readily available to meet with representatives of OU weekly during the first month of the contract and as often as necessary thereafter. A mutual effort will be made to resolve all performance problems identified at these meetings.

6.18 Federal, State and Local Reporting Compliance

The Firm shall provide such financial and programmatic information as required to comply with all Federal, State, and local law reporting requirements.

6.19 Project Personnel

Except as formally approved by OU, the key personnel identified in the accepted proposal shall be the individual who will complete the work, at the proposed levels of effort. Changes in staffing must be proposed in writing to OU and approved.

6.20 Notices

All written notices required to be given by either party under the terms of the contract(s) resulting from the contract award shall be addressed to the Firm at their legal business residence as given in the contract. Written notices to OU shall be addressed as provided in the contract.

6.21 Cancellation

Irrespective of any default hereunder, OU may also at any time at its discretion cancel any subsequent contract related to this solicitation, in whole or in part. In the event of cancellation, the Firm shall be entitled to receive equitable compensation for all work completed and accepted prior to such termination or cancellation as shall be indicated in the contract.

6.22 Travel

All travel and miscellaneous expenses related to this solicitation will be borne by the Firm unless otherwise provided in the contract for services.

6.23 Non-Discrimination

In accordance with the U.S. Constitution and all federal legislation and regulations governing fair employment practices and equal employment opportunity including, but not limited to Title VI (42 USC 2000d, et seq.) and Title VII (42 USC 2000e, et seq.) of the Civil Rights Act of 1964 (P.L. 88-352, 78 Stat. 241) and the U.S. Department of Justice regulations (28 CFR Part 42, et seq.) and the U.S. Department of Labor regulations (29 CFR Part 1601, et seq.) issued pursuant to those Titles, Executive Order 11246 (September 24, 1965) as amended, the Michigan Constitution and all state laws and regulations governing fair employment practices and equal employment opportunity, including but not limited to the Michigan Civil Rights Act (P.A. 1976 No. 453) and the Michigan Handicappers Civil Rights Act (P.A. 1976 No. 220), the Contractor agrees that it shall not discriminate against any employee or applicant for employment with respect to hire, tenure, terms, conditions or privileges of employment because of religion, race, color, national origin, age, sex, sexual orientation, height, weight, marital status or handicap that is unrelated to the individual's ability to perform the duties of a particular assignment or position. The Contractor hereby recognizes the right of the United States and the State of Michigan to seek judicial enforcement of the foregoing covenant against discrimination, against itself or its subcontractors connected directly or indirectly with the performance of this Contract.

ACCEPTANCE

Please indicate your acceptance of Oakland University's Terms and Conditions and the provisions stated in this RFQ in the space provided below. Complete the information at the bottom of this document and return this signed page with your RFQ response.

Thank you.

ACCEPTANCE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT:

I have reviewed and do accept Oakland University's Terms and Conditions as stated on the University web page. I have read and agree to abide by the terms of this RFQ. I also acknowledge that I am a legally authorized representative of the business entity noted below and, as such, have the authority to enter into agreements and make commitments on its behalf:

Company: _____	Address: _____
Authorized Signature: _____	Date: _____
Printed Name: _____	Title: _____
Phone #: _____	Email: _____

NOTE: OAKLAND UNIVERSITY RESERVES THE FOLLOWING RIGHTS: TO ACCEPT OR REJECT ANY BID; TO REJECT ALL BIDS; TO WAIVE ANY FORMALITIES OR IRREGULARITIES CONTAINED IN A BID THAT DO NOT COMPLY WITH THE TERMS AND CONDITIONS OF THE INVITATION TO BID, ANY MODIFICATIONS TO THE INVITATION TO BID, OR ANY SPECIFICATIONS; TO SELECT THE BID AND/OR ITEMS THAT IN THE SOLE AND ABSOLUTE DISCRETION OF OAKLAND UNIVERSITY ARE IN OAKLAND UNIVERSITY'S BEST INTEREST WHETHER OR NOT THE BID SELECTED IS THE LOWEST MONETARY BID RECEIVED.

SCHEDULE A – Addendum Acknowledgement

ADDENDA:

The undersigned affirms that the cost of all work covered by the following Addenda are included in the price of this proposal.

Addendum No. _____ Date: _____ Addendum No. _____ Date: _____

Addendum No. _____ Date: _____ Addendum No. _____ Date: _____

Addendum No. _____ Date: _____ Addendum No. _____ Date: _____

Firm Name: _____

SCHEDULE B-INSURANCE REQUIREMENTS ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

You must submit an insurance certificate (informational only) with your bid response.

_____, at its sole expense, shall cause to be issued and maintained in full effect for the term of this agreement, insurance as set forth hereunder:

Errors & Omissions (Tech E&O)	\$1,000,000 per occurrence, \$2,000,000 aggregate
Cyber Risk Liability	\$2,000,000 per occurrence, \$2,000,000 aggregate
Excess (Umbrella):	\$2,000,000 per occurrence

Respondents must provide an insurance certificate as part of their proposal submittal showing evidence of insurance. If you cannot currently meet the requirements proposals must include a statement agreeing to meet these requirements at no additional cost by the time of contract signing. Failure to meet this requirement in your RFQ response may eliminate your company's proposal.

1. Oakland University and its Board of Trustees must be listed as an "Additional Insured" on the Certificate of Insurance.
2. Supplier must provide an insurance certificate before commencing service delivery, must keep the certificate up-to-date, and must forward copies of all revised certificates of insurance to the Risk Management Department at Oakland University within thirty (30) days of the change.
3. Notice of cancellation must be submitted thirty (30) days prior to the termination of the insurance coverage.
4. Awarded Supplier shall notify the University of any Accidents and/or claims, including without limitation accidents or claims involving bodily injury, death or property damage, arising on or within the Licensed Premises. Such notice shall be provided in writing as soon as practicable, however in any event within five days of Awarded Supplier's receipt of notice of the accident or claim.
5. Required insurance coverage and any self-insured retention may be required to be modified by the University if, in the sole judgment of the University, the levels of risk associated with Awarded Supplier's operations require modification of such coverage.
6. Failure of the Awarded Supplier to obtain and maintain appropriate insurance as specified by the University, without gap, may be deemed a material breach of this license and at the sole discretion of the University may be cause for contract termination.

Exceptions to the above insurance requirements are to be approved, in writing, by the Office of Risk Management. Exceptions are determined by the type and nature of the contract and the individual contractor.

SCHEDULE C-COSTS

Supplier Name: _____

All items proposed by the Supplier should meet or exceed Oakland University's requirements. The University reserves the right to reject any equipment/service at its sole discretion.

The undersigned, as bidder, declares that he/she having examined the specifications with related documents hereby proposes to furnish the equipment and services in accordance with the specifications, within the time set forth therein, and at the cost stated below.

All pricing should be completed in Schedule C Excel Sheet provided.

Comments/Restrictions:

Submitted by: _____

Signature: _____

Title/Date: _____

(Title)

(Date)

Phone: _____ **Email:** _____

SCHEDULE D – IT Technical Compliance

After conclusion of negotiations but prior to award of a contract (and/or release of funding to procure your solution) your solution/system will be submitted to UTS (University Technology Services). UTS will review your solution against a variety of metrics including, security, accessibility, ease/ability to integrate with existing systems, etc. The supplier must agree to submit their solution and submit any requested information to assist in the review process.

The supplier should submit any of the applicable documents below and be prepared to provide additional items as requested. *Non-Disclosure agreements will be completed if required.*

- Third Party Assessments - System and Organization Controls (SOC) Type II *preferred*
- Higher Education Community Vendor Assessment Toolkit (HECVAT) Full
- Software Bill of Materials (SBOM) *preferred*
- Data Integration Guides / Architecture Diagrams
- Email Integration Guides / Architecture Diagrams
- Voluntary Product Accessibility (VPAT) statement for ADA compliance
- Single Sign On (SSO) Integration / Configuration
- Implementation Guides / Architecture Diagrams
- Data retention, destruction, and return processes
- Service Level Agreement (SLA) language
- End User License Agreement (EULA)
- Any additional documentation or items requested during the review process

If the supplier is unable to provide applicable documentation, please include the rationale in the proposal.

Please indicate any of the following types of protected data the proposed solution will have access to:

☐ Health Information ☐ Credit Card ☐ Financial Aid ☐ Student Information
☐ Regulated Data ☐ Other _____

ACKNOWLEDGMENT; This Amendment must be signed and returned with your proposal

Signature

Date

SECURITY DOCUMENTATION DEFINITIONS

As part of the procurement process University Technology Services (UTS) requests various types of documentation to aid in evaluating the security of a product or solution. The following documents typically provide UTS with the vast majority of information required for an assessment and are the most efficient way to initiate a review.

- Higher Education Community Vendor Assessment Toolkit (HECVAT) Full
- Service Organization Control (SOC) Type II Report
- Software Bill of Materials (SBoM)
- [OU E-MAIL SECURITY QUESTIONNAIRE](#)

As not all parties involved with a purchase may be familiar with these documents and their importance we would like to address some commonly asked questions below:

- What is the [Higher Education Community Vendor Assessment Toolkit \(HECVAT\) Full](#)?
 - The HECVAT is a questionnaire framework specifically designed for higher education to measure vendor risk. There are two versions of this document, the 'Lite' and the more comprehensive 'Full' version. Completing the HECVAT Full allows an institution to evaluate that the information, data, and cybersecurity policies are in place to protect our sensitive institutional information and constituents' PII.
- What is a [Service Organization Control \(SOC\) 2 Type II Report](#)?
 - SOC compliance and audits are intended for organizations that provide services to other organizations and involve a third-party auditor validating the service provider's controls and systems to ensure that it can provide the desired services.
- What is a Software Bill of Materials(SBoM)?
 - The software bill of materials (SBOM) lists all component parts and software dependencies used in application development and delivery.
- What is the [OU E-MAIL SECURITY QUESTIONNAIRE](#)?
 - The [OU E-MAIL SECURITY QUESTIONNAIRE](#) is applicable to vendors / services that will be using OU to communicate with OU constituents. The purpose of the document is to gather information to ensure that email is delivered in accordance with OU standards and maximizes the likelihood email will be delivered properly (e.g. not flagged as junk, phishing).
- Why are these documents requested?

- To some extent all purchases require an ongoing partnership between OU and the vendor. This relationship can be limited in scope (for example from local usernames and passwords) to complex integrations that involve interconnecting applications and networks together. In order to ensure that university policies and legal & contractual obligations are being met UTS must thoroughly vet each proposed solution to ensure it meets minimum requirements and any risks are communicated, documented, and accepted.
- Are these documents required?
 - At this time these documents are strongly desired but not required for all purchases. However, as the HECVAT can be completed as a self-assessment UTS suggests that all vendors complete this document as it demonstrates a commitment to security awareness and best practices.